



SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

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Topic:	BEING PREPARED FOR EMERGENCIES				

This briefing is not intended to tell you how to do your jobs, it is designed to help keep you safe. We want everybody to be able to return home safely to their family and friends at the end of each day.

Would you know what to do if an emergency occurred while you were at work? Do you know what actions to take if a colleague was seriously injured, a fire ignited, or a structure collapsed?

Emergencies and disasters are a reality of everyday life. Too many lives are lost and property is damaged because no one was prepared to properly react when immediate decisions and actions counted.

A good start in learning how to respond to an emergency is through certification in Basic First Aid and CPR (Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation). These courses teach important skills. But even more important than the first aid skills gained, they teach how to respond to an emergency. Courses are available to teach people about the kind of situations or conditions that might precipitate an emergency. Knowing what to look for and how to react could save the life of a co-worker or family member.

Your company should have an emergency action plan. Review it periodically and be aware of what steps to follow when calling for emergency help. Know the course of action to take in likely emergencies. This will improve your safety awareness in everything you do.

Safety awareness may be gained through the company's regular safety meetings, safety training or your own personal interest in safety & health. This awareness will increase your ability to respond if, some day in the future, you are a bystander in an emergency. This is particularly important if you work in a hazardous industry. You should be able to answer the following:

- How and who do you notify in an emergency?
- Are you prepared to react responsibly?
- Should you stay with the injured person or run for help?
- If you are not First Aid certified, do you know who in your in the company is?
- Does the emergency scene need to be secured?
- Do you know the chain of command? Who is in charge during an emergency?

You come to work every day prepared for the task at hand and knowledgeable on how to handle problems in the workplace. Being mentally aware is also your best preparation for a potential emergency. Analyse beforehand what to do if one of your co-workers is injured, and if that injury is life threatening. Know how to protect yourself, your co-workers and the company in case of a serious incident. Chances are, during a crisis, you will not have much time to plan the best possible action-so make those decisions ahead of time.

**Discussion Points**

Does everyone know who the first aiders are?

Is everyone aware of where the emergency action plan is located?

Which is the best way to get help / emergency services (999 can gps the mobile)?